The Wealth of Nations

An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of the Wealth of Nations

By Adam Smith

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Newly typeset archival edition of Adam Smith's 1776 treatise on the division of labour, trade, price formation, and public institutions.

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BOOK I, CHAPTER I

Of the Division of Labour

Complete 1776 Text

The greatest improvement in the productive powers of labour, and the greater part of the skill, dexterity, and judgment with which it is any where directed, or applied, seem to have been the effects of the division of labour.

In this section of The Wealth of Nations (1776), Adam Smith develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in business & finance and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by W. Strahan and T. Cadell, in the Strand and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg, ID: pg-3300), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

BOOK I, CHAPTER II

Of the Principle which gives Occasion to the Division of Labour

*The Wealth of Nations * Adam Smith (1776)*

Of the Principle which gives Occasion to the Division of Labour continues Adam Smith's inquiry in The Wealth of Nations. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Newly added to the Folio Digital Archive in a freshly proofed five-book edition, Adam Smith's 1776 treatise laid the foundations of modern economics.

Throughout Book I, Chapter II (Of the Principle which gives Occasion to the Division of Labour), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Wealth of Nations its stature in the Classical Political Economy canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Adam Smith traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

BOOK I, CHAPTER III

That the Division of Labour is Limited by the Extent of the Market

*The Wealth of Nations * Adam Smith (1776)*

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BOOK IV

Of Systems of Political Economy

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BOOK V

Of the Revenue of the Sovereign or Commonwealth

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